



## Ridge Augmentation

**Purpose:** Surgical procedure to rebuild or increase the height and width of the jawbone ridge, often to prepare for dental implants.

**First 24–72 Hours:**

- Swelling, bruising, and mild bleeding are common.
- Apply ice packs to the outside of the face for 15–20 minutes at a time during the first day.
- Keep head elevated to reduce swelling.

**Pain & Sensitivity:**

- Take prescribed pain relievers and antibiotics as directed.
- Some numbness in the area may occur temporarily.

**Oral Hygiene:**

- Brush teeth carefully, avoiding the surgical site.
- Begin gentle antimicrobial or warm salt water rinses 24 hours after surgery.

**Diet:**

- Soft foods for at least one week.
- Avoid chewing on the surgical side and stay away from hard or crunchy foods.

**Special Precautions:**

- Do not smoke or consume alcohol during healing.
- Avoid disturbing the site with your tongue or fingers.

**Follow-Up:**

- Attend follow-up visits to check bone graft stability and healing progress.
- Contact your dentist if bleeding persists, swelling worsens after 3 days, or signs of infection appear.